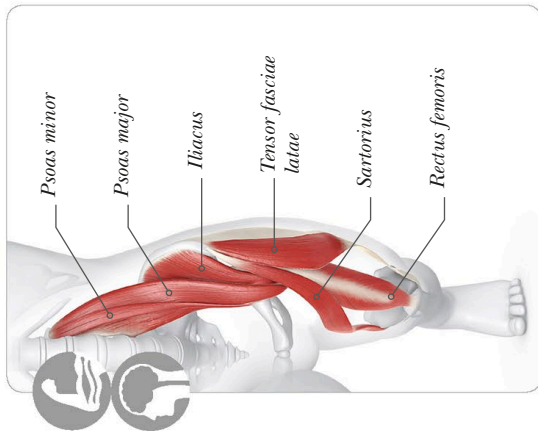
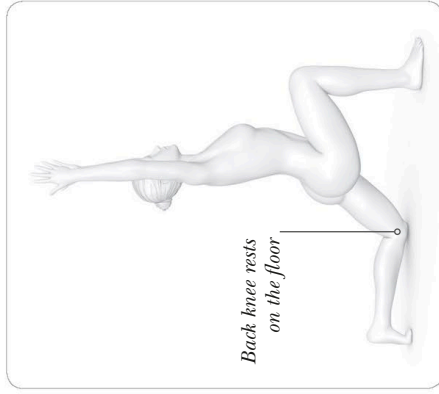
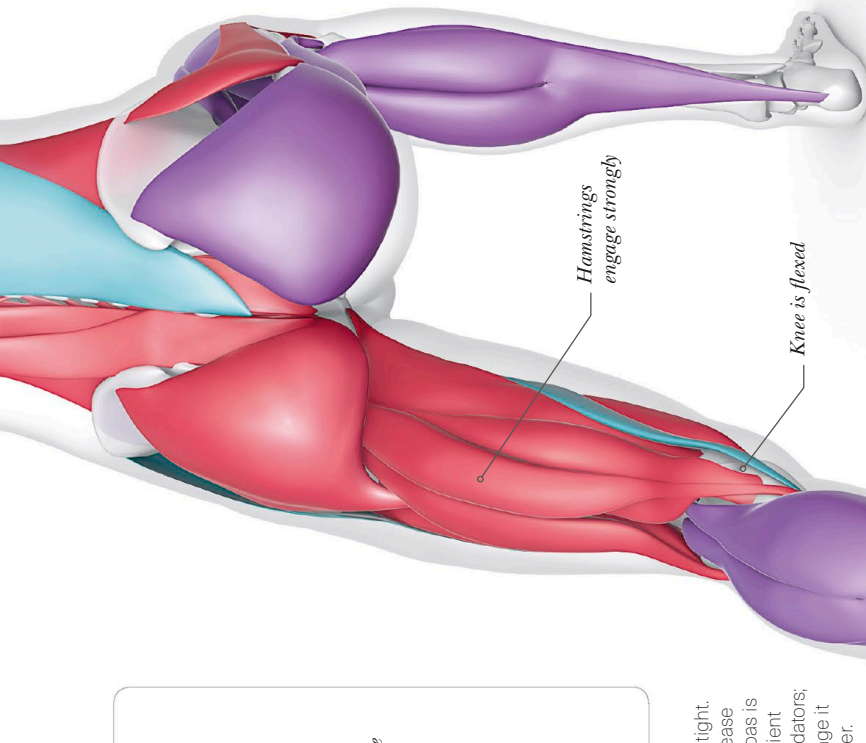




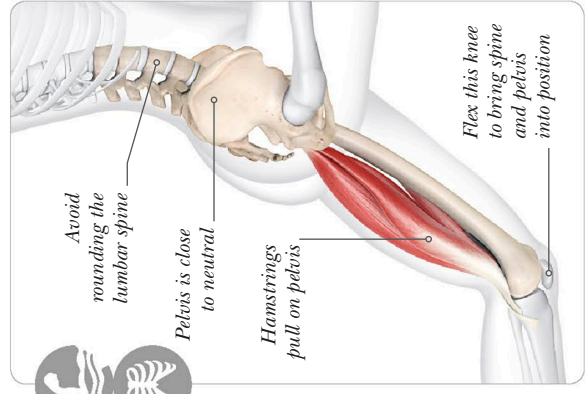
Hip flexors

If you sit a lot, your hip flexors may be tight. You may feel a profound sense of release following this asana, because your psoas is considered a fear reflex muscle. Ancient humans would engage it to run from predators; modern humans unconsciously engage it while stressed, seated at a computer.



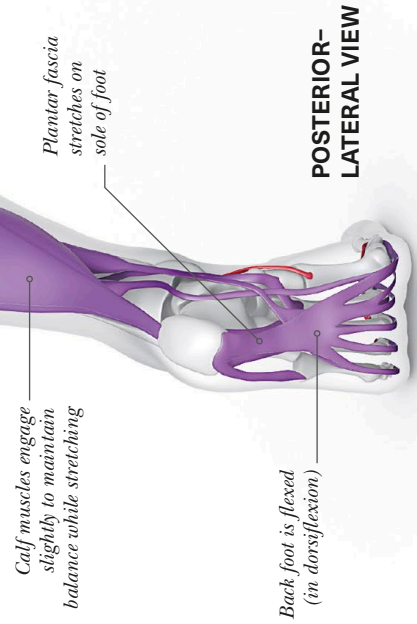
VARIATION

Place your back knee on the floor or on a folded blanket to reduce intensity. You could also place your hands on the floor to take balance out of the equation, allowing you to focus solely on stretching.



Tight hamstrings

If your hamstrings are tight, they may be pulling your pelvis into posterior tilt and rounding your lumbar spine. If this is you, or if you feel pinching in your lower back, try bending your back knee into flexion to lessen the pull on your hamstrings, coming to a more neutral position.



POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW